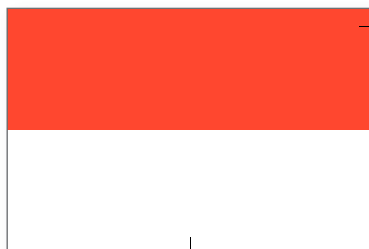


Indonesia

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** August 17, 1945 **Usage:** National and Civil

The flag is based on the banner of the 13th-century Indonesian Empire



Red represents the body

White symbolizes the soul

Asia



A former Dutch colony, **Indonesia** gained independence in 1949. Western New Guinea (Irian Jaya) was ceded to Indonesia in 1963.

The flag is based on the banner of the 13th-century Empire of Majahapit, red and white being the holy colors of Indonesia at that time. These colors were revived in the 20th century as an expression of nationalism against the Dutch. The first red and white flag flew in Java in 1928 and was adopted

as the national flag of the republic in 1945 when the country declared its independence. The red stripe is symbolic of physical life, while white represents spiritual life. Together they stand for the complete human being, body and soul. Red and white are also traditional colors of the Southeast Asian nations.

ARMS OF INDONESIA

The arms show a shield supported by a mythical bird, the garuda. The 17 wing-feathers and 8 tail-feathers refer to the day and month (August 17) on which independence was declared in 1945



The shield depicts a buffalo head, a banyan tree, and sheaves of rice and cotton

The yellow star represents religious belief

The national motto means "Unity in Diversity"